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Topic: Active Directory Certificate Services (AD CS) Practicald

1. **Install the Active Directory Certificate Services (AD CS) role on your Windows Server VM and take a screenshot of the 'Role Services' selection screen.**

⇒ Open Server Manager.
Click Manage → Add Roles and Features.
Click Next until Server Roles.
Check Active Directory Certificate Services.
Click Add Features.
Click Next.
On the Role Services page, select:
Certification Authority
Click Next.
Click Install

2. **Configure a new Standalone Root Certification Authority (CA) using the AD CS wizard and set the common name to 'CampusAppCA'.**

⇒ After installation, click the notification flag.
Select Configure Active Directory Certificate Services.
Select your server.
Choose:
Certification Authority
Setup Type
Choose:
Standalone CA
CA Type
Choose:
Root CA
Private Key
Choose:
Create a new private key
Cryptography
Leave the default settings.
Common Name
Enter:
CampusAppCA
Accept the default validity period.
Click Configure.

3. Issue a user certificate for a test user account (e.g., 'testuser') from your CA and export the certificate as a .cer file.

⇒ Step 1 – Create Test User

Open

Active Directory Users and Computers

Create a user:

Username:

testuser

Step 2 – Open Certification Authority

Go to

Server Manager

↓

Tools

↓

Certification Authority

Step 3 – Certificate Template

Enable the User certificate template if needed.

Step 4 – Request Certificate

Open

MMC

↓

Certificates

↓

Current User

↓

Personal

↓

Certificates

Request a new certificate.

Choose

User

Complete the wizard.

Step 5 – Export Certificate

Right-click certificate

All Tasks

↓

Export

Choose

No Private Key

Save as

testuser.cer

**4. Simulate a Flipkart-style secure login: Configure your server to require client certificate authentication for a test web application and attempt to log in using the issued certificate.

Hint: You can use IIS and map client certificates to user accounts for this demo.**

- ⇒ Step 1
 - Install IIS
 - Server Manager
 - ↓
 - Add Roles
 - ↓
 - Web Server (IIS)
- ⇒ Step 2
 - Create a simple webpage
 - Example
 - C:\inetpub\wwwroot
 - Create
 - index.html
- ⇒ Step 3
 - Open IIS Manager
 - Server Manager
 - ↓
 - Tools
 - ↓
 - Internet Information Services (IIS)
- ⇒ Step 4
 - Select
 - Default Web Site
- ⇒ Step 5
 - Open
 - SSL Settings
 - Check
 - Require SSL
- ⇒ Step 6
 - Open
 - Authentication
 - Enable
- ⇒ Client Certificate Mapping Authentication
- Step 7
 - Map
 - testuser Certificate
 - ↓
 - testuser Account
- ⇒ Step 8
 - Browse

https://ServerName
Browser requests
Select Certificate
Choose
testuser

5. Use ChatGPT to generate a step-by-step checklist for troubleshooting common AD CS installation errors, and apply one of the steps to intentionally misconfigure your CA, then fix it using the checklist.

- ⇒ Step 1
Verify you are logged in as an Administrator.
- Step 2
Confirm Active Directory Certificate Services is installed.
- Step 3
Check required Windows services:
Remote Procedure Call (RPC)
Windows Event Log
DCOM Server Process Launcher
- Step 4
Open Event Viewer and check:
Windows Logs → Application
Windows Logs → System
- Step 5
Verify the CA configuration:
CA Type
Private Key
Common Name
- Step 6
Restart the Active Directory Certificate Services service.
- Step 7
Verify CampusAppCA appears in the Certification Authority console.
- Intentional Misconfiguration
While configuring AD CS, select:
Subordinate CA
instead of
Standalone Root CA
- ⇒ Result:
The configuration fails because a Subordinate CA requires an existing parent CA.
- ⇒ Fix
Open Configure Active Directory Certificate Services.
- ⇒ Select:
 - ✓ Standalone CA
 - ✓ Root CA

Create a new private key.

Enter the common name:

CampusAppCA

Complete the wizard.

Verify that CampusAppCA appears in the Certification Authority console.

Result:

The CA is successfully configured, and certificate services work correctly.

